

THE MIRROR · 03

03

THE PARENT

MIRROR

Breathe before you start. There are no right answers in this lesson.

Only honest ones.

A PROMISE, BEFORE WE START

THIS IS NOT A LESSON ABOUT BLAME.

You are not a bad parent for wanting good things for your kid. The point of this work isn't guilt — it's awareness. Awareness is the first tool.

THE THING NOBODY SAYS OUT LOUD

A LOT OF WHAT WE CALL
"SUPPORT" IS ACTUALLY
EXTENSION —

the dream we didn't finish. The scholarship we didn't get. The championship we lost in overtime. We wrap it in love and call it support. Underneath — something else is driving.

THE MIRROR PROTOCOL

THREE QUESTIONS.
READ THEM SLOWLY.

Notice what your body does before your mind does. The flinch is the signal. The flinch is the data. These answers are for you. Not for her.

PRIVATE REFLECTION NO SHARING REQUIRED



— LOOK HONESTLY —

Q1

WHAT WOULD IT MEAN TO ME
IF MY ATHLETE QUIT HER
SPORT TOMORROW?

Panic. Relief. Nothing. Each is information. None is wrong. All of them tell you how much of your identity is wrapped in her sport.

Q2

WHEN I WATCH HER PLAY —

WHOSE PERFORMANCE AM I

ACTUALLY WATCHING?

My father told me he had to ask himself this when I was sixteen. He said the answer changed now he watched every game after that." — Gabby

Q3

WHAT WOULD I DO ON A
SATURDAY IF I WASN'T AT HER
GAME?

If the answer is "I don't know," "I'd feel empty," or "nothing" — you've built your weekly life around her performance. That is not her burden to carry.

YOUR ROLE, REDEFINED

NOT THE SECOND
COACH. THE **BASE.**

The constant. The soft landing. The person who would love her exactly the same if she never played another game.

THE 20-MINUTE CAR RIDE THAT MAKES OR BREAKS THE WEEK

STOP DEBRIEFING. START DECOMPRESSING.

WHAT MOST PARENTS DO

DEBRIEF

So what did coach say about that play?
You were too slow out of serve receive.
Let's watch film tonight.
You have to want it more than the other girls.

WHAT THE BASE DOES

DECOMPRESS

What are you hungry for?
How's Sophia doing after that ankle thing?
I loved watching you out there today.
Anything you want to talk about — I'm here.

SAY THIS TONIGHT

" I LOVE
WATCHING
YOU PLAY. "

ix words to combat his critique. No variations. Just presence. Just close your mouth.